

EarthCube Oceanography and
Geobiology Environmental 'Omics



ECOGEO Workshop 2: Introduction to Env 'Omics

Amplicon Analysis - mothur

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mothur Background - 1

- 1 of 2 majorly used pipelines for the analysis of 16S rRNA amplicon sequences – Qiime
 - iTagger (JGI)
- “mothur is currently the most cited bioinformatics tool for analyzing 16S rRNA gene sequences. ...[T]he wiki and user forum and [contain] how you can use mothur to process data generated by Sanger, PacBio, IonTorrent, 454, and Illumina (MiSeq/HiSeq).”

mothur Background - 2

“mothur and QIIME” P. Schloss (2016) -
<http://blog.mothur.org/2016/01/12/mothur-and-qiime/>

In reference to reviewers: [T]he differences that they think are huge are largely cosmetic.”

Many of the same functions are available in both: cleaning sequences, clustering OTUs, determining alpha and beta diversities, generation of BIOM format documents

Differences

Mothur	Qiime
All functions coded in to a single program in C	Written as a wrapper script in Python – individual aspect coded elsewhere
Fully open source	Open source – except for components that are not
Development progresses mainly through Schloss lab	Lots of collaboration – additional tools, etc
Parameter rich – lots of explanations about defaults	Parameter rich – limited explanation about details
No build in data viz	Built in data viz
OTU clustering – time intensive, heavily supported results	OTU clustering – faster, multiple options, results may vary
Classify with naïve Bayesian algorithm	Classify with USEARCH. Requires 2 top matches for assignment. DB order sensitive.
Database – default SILVA (Ref123), able to integrate other DBs	Database – default greengenes (2013), able to use other DBs

Essential mothur - 1

Remember both mothur and Qiime offer multi-day workshops that delve in to the minutiae and details of these methods – now less than 30 min

Based on the MiSeq Standard Operating Procedure - http://mothur.org/wiki/MiSeq_SOP

Essential mothur - 2

Reducing sequencing & PCR errors

- make.contigs
 - Schloss lab uses fully overlapping forward and reverse reads to increase fidelity of results
- Remove all sequences that have ambiguities and cannot exist in reality (too long after complete overlap join)

Essential mothur - 3

Align and trim

- Align sequences to the reference database
- Trim sequences outside of target hypervariable region(s)
- Important to know the position of primers on the fully expanded 16S rRNA alignment!

Essential mothur - 4

Reduce complexity of sequences

- Combine all identical sequences
- Remove chimeric sequences
- Identify sequences aligned to lineages that “cannot” be in your sample → Chloroplast, Eukaryote, etc.

Essential mothur - 5

Make OTUs

- Cluster sequences into OTUs – 97% similarity
- Produce OTU table outputs
- Assign OTUs a putative taxonomy

Essential mothur - 6

Analysis

- Alpha diversity - mean species diversity (no. of species present)
- Broad comparisons between samples and observed richness
 - Rarefaction – counts the number of observed OTUs as the number of sequences analyzed increases
 - Chao 1 – creates an estimate that increases the weight of the presence of rare OTUs
 - Inverse Simpson – “indication of the richness in a community with uniform evenness that would have the same level of diversity”

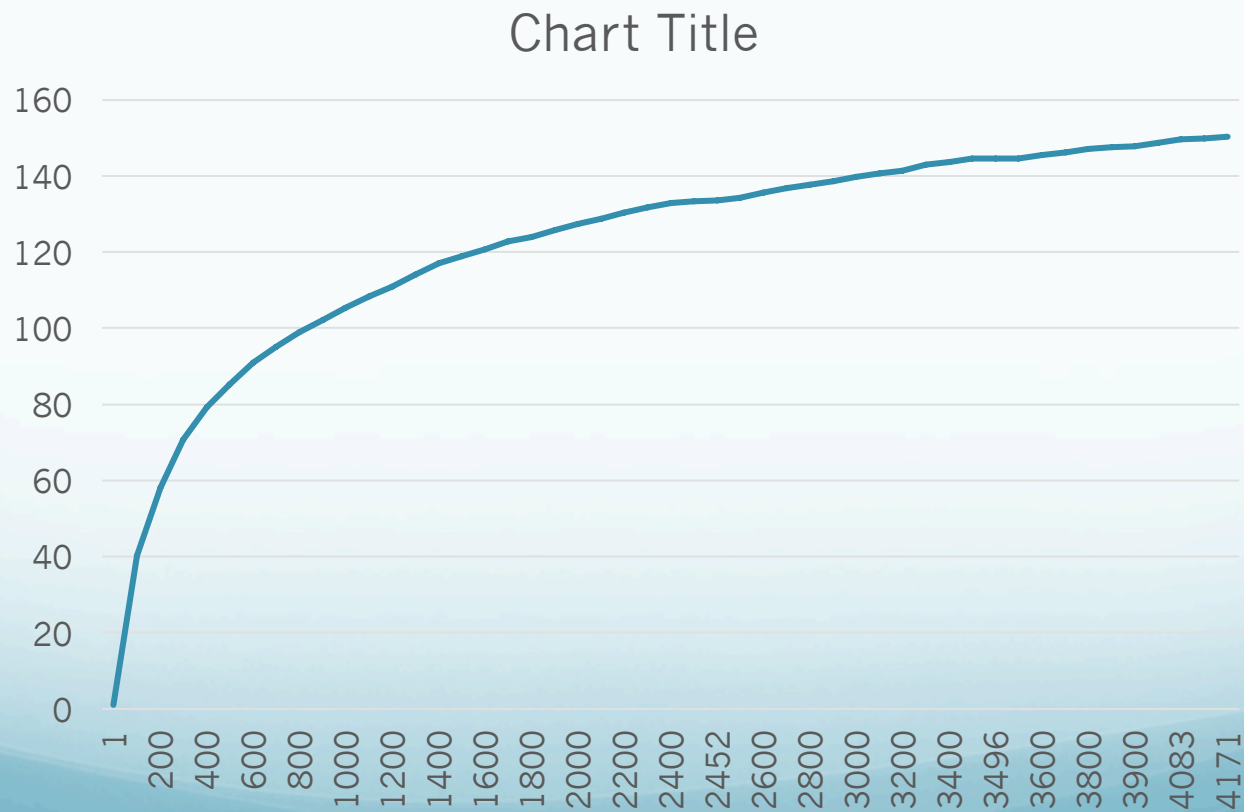
```
$ cd /home/c-debi/ecogeo/mothurdir
$ mothur
```

[illegible]

mothur (Hands-On) - 2

```
$ cut -f1,2 stability.an.groups.rarefaction > sample1.rarefaction
```

Creates file with data for rarefaction curve (nano)



mothur (Hands-On) - 3

Alpha diversity measures

```
mothur > summary.single(shared=stability.an.shared, calc=nseqs-coverage-  
sobs-invsimpson, subsample=2441)
```

```
$ less stability.an.groups.ave-std.summary
```

Sample	No. seqs used	Observed Species	Inv. Simpson	Confidence interval - L	Confidence interval - H
F3D0	2441	132.734	25.716	24.093	27.574
F3D1	2441	127.36	34.539	32.539	37.032

mothur (Hands-On) - 4

What about bar graphs with relative abundance and taxonomy?

```
$ less stability.an.cons.taxonomy
```

```
OTU  Size  Taxonomy
Otu0001  12328
```

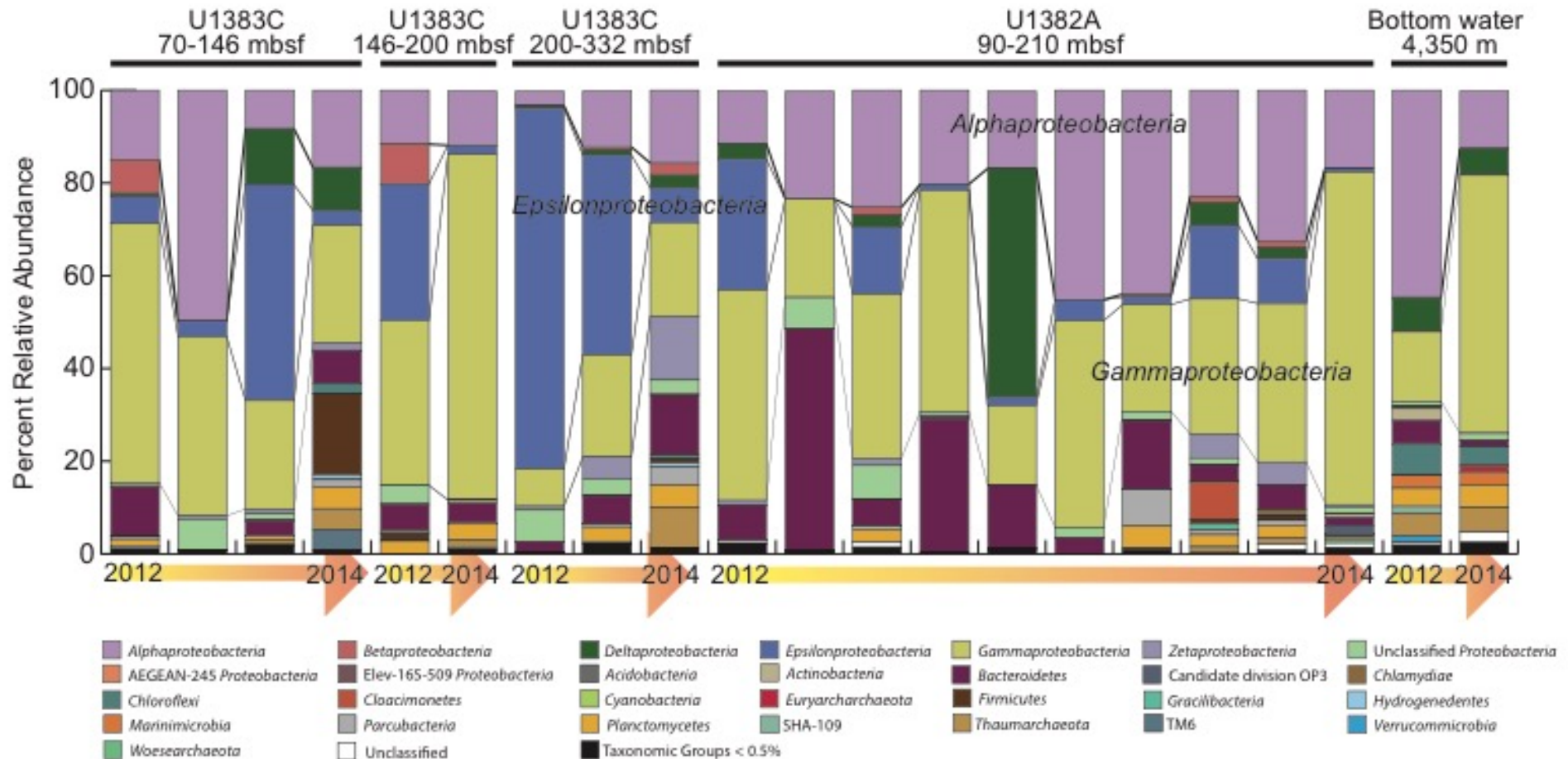
```
Bacteria(100);"Bacteroidetes"(100);"Bacteroidia"(100);"Bacteroidales"(100);"Porphyromonadaceae"(100);"Porphyromonadaceae"_unclassified(100);"Porphyromonadaceae"_unclassified(100);"Porphyromonadaceae"_unclassified_unclassified(100);
```

```
mothur > sub.sample(shared=stability.an.shared, size=2241)
```

```
$ less stability.an.0.03.subsample.shared
```

label	Group	numOtu	Otu0001	Otu0002	Otu0003	Otu0004	Otu0005	Otu0006	Otu0007
0.03	F3D0	296	181	116	132	201	164	132	

mothur (Hands-On) - 5



Unrelated data

Essential mothur - 7

Analysis

- Beta diversity - measured differences between communities
- How related are communities to each other?
 - Theta YC (community structure) – considers shared OTUs and relative abundance of OTUs
 - Jaccard (community membership) – compared which OTUs are present in samples

mothur (Hands-On) - 6

Beta diversity measures

```
mothur > dist.shared(shared=stability.an.shared, calc=thetayc-jclass,  
subsample=2241)
```

Turn distance measure output in to a dendrogram

```
mothur > tree.shared(phylip=stability.an.thetayc.0.03.lt.ave.dist)  
mothur > quit()
```

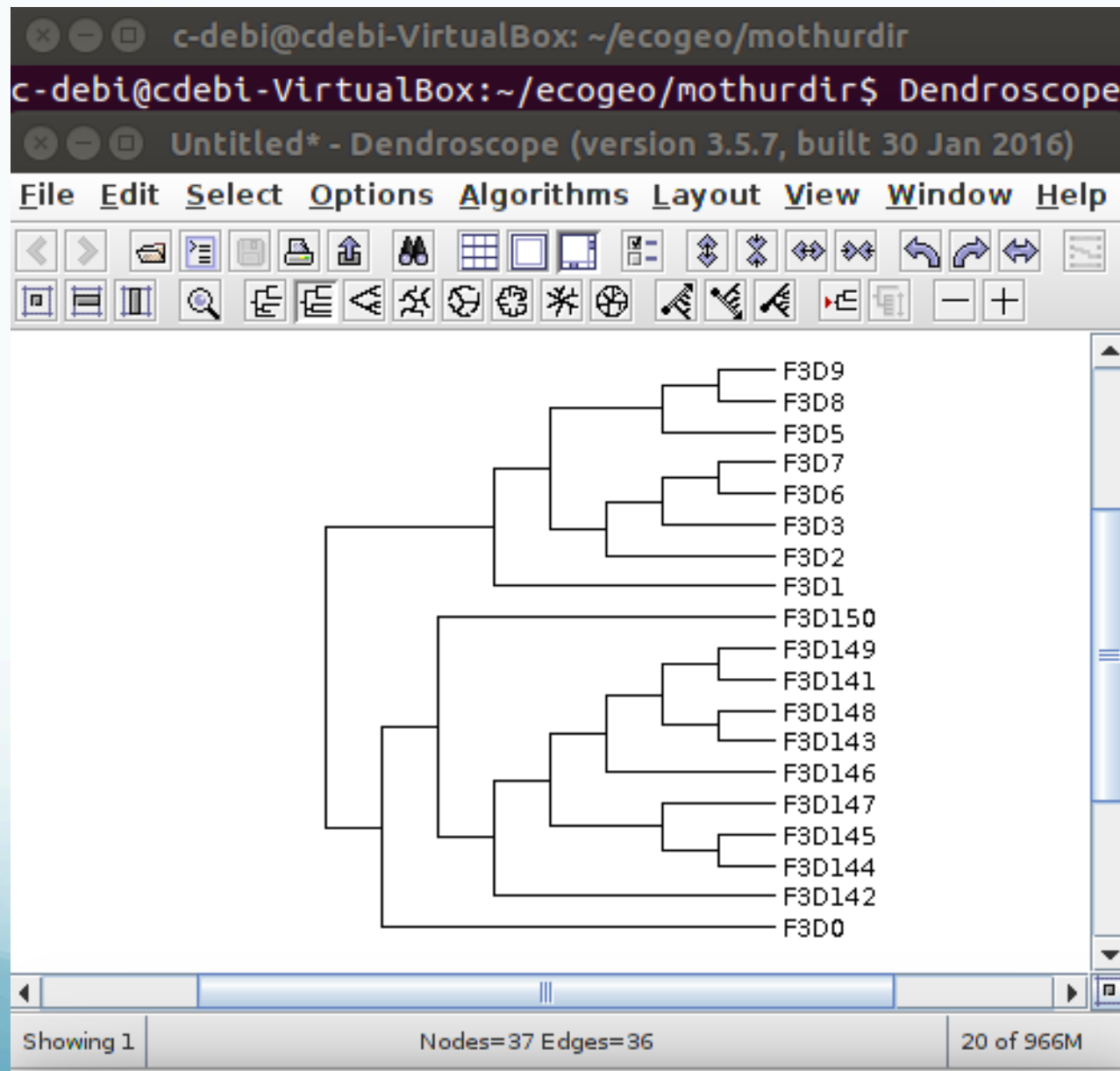
```
$ less stability.an.thetayc.0.03.lt.ave.tre
```

Copy content

```
$ Dendroscope
```

Edit, paste

mothur (Hands-On) - 7



Essential mothur - 8

Statistical significance

- Involves classifying your samples in to categories → good experimental design would have classify these samples before seeing results
 - E.g. surface vs deep samples or winter vs. summer
- Generate points to plot Principal Component Analysis or Non-metric Dimensional Scaling plots
- Perform AMOVA statistical tests